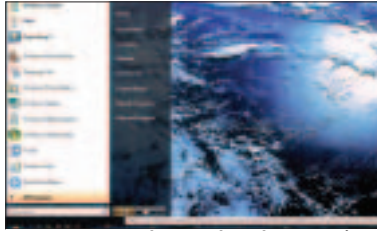


ed in free-form. You can save snips to a folder or email them to friends. Go to Start > Control Panel > Programs and click 'Turn Windows features on or off' to install the Tablet PC Optional Components, which includes the Snipping Tool.

13. Adapt to suit

Vista's Ease of Access Center makes it simple to tweak Windows so it works the way you want it to. Whether you'd simply like to make items appear a little larger on the screen or have an impairment, the Ease of Access Center enables you to work around such issues.



Put your PC to sleep rather than turn it off altogether; it'll start noticeably quicker

14. Make a pretty picture

Windows XP's ability to store, edit and organise images needed a makeover — and it has been given one in Vista. Photo Gallery enables you to carry out simple editing tasks such as correcting red-eye or adding tags to images to make it easier to manage them and email them to friends. You can even use Photo Gallery to create a DVD slideshow that can be viewed on your TV.

15. Sleep easy

The older a PC gets, the longer it takes to start up and shut down as Windows launches or stops applications and loads updates. Click the gold power button from the Start menu and Vista saves your current documents and settings before switching to a low-power state. This means that when you start the PC up again, the computer doesn't have to go through that lengthy startup process. A real boon for people who use their PC often.

16. Listen to your voice

Tired of typing text into documents and weary of pushing a mouse around to navigate folders? Try telling Vista what to do instead. The Speech Recognition tool, in conjunction with a headset that includes a microphone, means you can do just that. You need to complete a tutorial so that Vista can 'learn' your voice and we have to say that it works far easier for dictating text into a document

than actually controlling Windows, but it's definitely worth checking out.

17. Take control

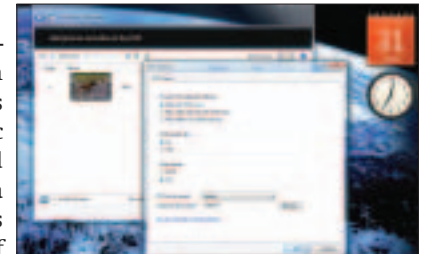
Vista introduces us to a feature called User Account Control. This tool makes sure that only you are permitted to make changes to settings, install programs or initiate internet access. There is an abundance of web nasties (not to mention mischievous household members) that are happy to throw a spanner in the works — User Account Control is a vital protective barrier against their wicked ways.



Command your computer with only your voice

18. Play the game

If you like playing the occasional computer game in your free time, whether it's a flight simulator, a frantic shoot-em-up or a civilised game of solitaire, Vista brings all your games together in one place. Of interest to parents will be the ability to hide specific games by age-rating, while those who like to take on the latest 3D games can access performance-tweaking options.



Windows DVD Maker is a simply-but-effective tool for burning video, photo and data DVDs

19. Make a date

One thing XP users lack is a decent calendar. Vista corrects this oversight with a simple calendar that can even be shared online with family and friends. It's a handy way for clubs and societies to keep track of activities when more than one member is organising events, and can display a choice of four views, from a single day to the full month ahead.

20. Burn a blockbuster

Vista finally includes a DVD-writing application as standard, and